Yuruo (Lisa) Lei

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Instructional designer specializing in online course development, faculty partnership, and AI-integrated learning experiences in higher education. Experienced across the full design lifecycle, from learner analysis and backward design to LMS build (Canvas, Brightspace, Coursera), quality assurance, and accessibility (Quality Matters, ADA). Known for scaling faculty programs, compressing course build cycles, and translating learner data into actionable design decisions.

EXPERIENCE

Instructional Designer **June 2024 – Present**

Vanderbilt University | Nashville, TN

- Led end-to-end design of 7 Coursera microlearning courses, 12+ graduate-level online courses, 3 certificate programs, and 10 async faculty trainings across Brightspace and Coursera, expanding Vanderbilt's online reach to 4,500+ learners.
- Conducted learner behavior analysis across 104 Coursera courses using R and AI, informing a Coursera development roadmap revamp that expanded faculty reach from 1 to 3 colleges and compressed the course support cycle from 12 weeks to 3 structured consultations.
- Partnered with a faculty development SME to convert a 2-day in-person workshop into a 4-module async program, leveraging AI to build comic-based branching scenarios, eliminating roughly $2,200 in per-cohort costs and scaling reach from 40 to 400+ faculty annually.
- Cut course build cycles from 9 to 4 months by designing a reusable Brightspace template system with custom HTML/CSS, improving UI/UX consistency and accessibility across all online course offerings.
- Designed a QM-aligned QA rubric adopted team-wide, cutting per-course review time from a full workday to under 3 hours while maintaining alignment with Quality Matters and ADA standards.
- Designed AI-integrated assessments that guide students to use AI responsibly and productively, including an AI-powered language-impairment interaction simulation built with Claude Code for a graduate Special Education course; 87% of students agreed the assessments deepened their understanding of AI and honed their AI skills.

Instructional Design Consultant / Project Manager (Part-Time, Volunteer) **March 2025 – June 2025**

Yale School of Medicine | Remote

- Built a reusable workshop infrastructure for nurse training, including a PowerPoint template, a consolidated content library sourced and reorganized from existing SME materials, and a Google Sheets RACI tracker, cutting workshop preparation time from 2 weeks to under 1 week.
- Collaborated with 3 SMEs to design multi-format nurse training materials (interactive webpages, PDF job aids, and slide decks), informed by a comparative analysis of peer nurse training programs to identify the most effective delivery model.

Curriculum Designer / Academic Advisor **May 2023 – May 2024**

Thinktown Education | New York, NY

- Designed a full-cycle qualitative research course for high school students from scratch, guiding learners from gap identification through literature review, data collection, analysis, and final presentation, then piloted it with 5 students to 100% completion.
- Launched a consumer psychology workshop to promote the research program, producing Canva slides and 10+ TikTok videos, converting 3 of 7 workshop participants into research course enrollees.

Course Assistant **September 2022 – May 2024**

Teachers College, Columbia University | New York, NY

- Supported 2 faculty members across a web design/coding course and a digital learning design course, assisting with lesson planning, classroom management, and real-time instructional support for 60+ students.
- Hosted regular office hours as the primary student-faculty liaison, fielding questions across course content and technical tools; nominated as Outstanding Teaching Assistant for the 2022–2023 academic year.

Instructional Technology Assistant **August 2023 – April 2024**

Columbia Video Network | New York, NY

- Supported filming of 10 Columbia Engineering online programs, managing media equipment, operating cameras, syncing recordings to Panopto, and troubleshooting media systems for faculty.
- Facilitated hybrid learning sessions for courses with simultaneous in-person and online audiences, managing Zoom engagement, relaying student questions to guest speakers, and adjusting live camera framing in real time.

Instructional Designer (Project-Based) **October 2022 – November 2023**
Teachers College & Heidelberg School of Education | New York, NY

- Designed a critical media literacy course for a joint TC-Heidelberg University initiative, structuring a 4-section curriculum grounded in inoculation theory to address media literacy gaps across the U.S. and Germany.
- Developed the course in Canvas using Lumi (H5P/SCORM), converting content into accessible, interoperable packages for cross-institutional delivery.

Instructional Designer Intern **May 2023 – August 2023**
School of Professional Studies, Columbia University | New York, NY

- Designed and facilitated an Empathic Course Design workshop for 12 SMEs; 4 participants reached out post-session for deeper collaboration and resources.
- Supported development of 4 master-level Canvas courses by reviewing learning objective and assessment alignment, and shadowing faculty consultations to deepen ID practice.

Instructional Designer / Product Manager **May 2020 – June 2021**
iFLYTEK | Shanghai, China

- Served as the sole education specialist on a 7-person team to design a story-based English learning journey for K-8 learners, developing character narratives, aligning vocabulary and sentence structures to CEFR A2 milestones, and grounding content in market research across widely-used Chinese English textbooks.
- Leveraged iFLYTEK's AI system to build 12 gamified modules reaching 50,000+ learners; the product received national media coverage and remains iFLYTEK's best-selling educational product.

EDUCATION

Ed.M., Instructional Technology & Media, *Teachers College, Columbia University* 2024
B.S./B.A., Bilingual Education & Psychology, *Boston University (GPA: 3.91)* 2022

PUBLICATIONS

5 peer-reviewed publications on educational technology, youth media, and the learning sciences, including 2 journal articles in Global Media and China and 3 conference proceedings presented at the International Conference of the Learning Sciences (ICLS), 2023 and 2024. Full citations available upon request.

SKILLS

Instructional Design & Pedagogy: Backward design, learner behavior analysis, needs assessment, curriculum development, faculty partnership, QA rubric design, Quality Matters and ADA accessibility.
Authoring & LMS: Articulate Rise, Adobe Captivate, Canvas, Brightspace, Coursera, Lumi (H5P/SCORM).
Multimedia & Design: Figma, Canva, Loom, CapCut, Panopto, Miro.
Technical & Data: HTML/CSS/JavaScript, R, Python, AI tools (Claude Code, Gemini).

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Professional Life Coach (CPLC), International Association of Professional Recovery Coaches, 2025.